The CoffeeScript implementation of the coffee machine appears side by side with an equivalent JavaScript implementation in the next listing. See how many differences you can spot.

Listing 2.2. Comparing CoffeeScript to JavaScript



When you compare the CoffeeScript and JavaScript in listing 2.2, you'll notice four key things that CoffeeScript is missing. It has no `var` statements, semicolons, `return` statements, or curly braces.

Var statements

In JavaScript, unless you're in strict mode it's possible to accidentally assign variables on the global object, in the global scope. If you don't know what that means, for now just know it's a bad thing. CoffeeScript always defines new variables in the current scope, protecting you from this unfortunate feature in JavaScript.